

PASTORNAMA

# "My experience with Christian leaders transformed me"

**HARPREET DEOL,** *42*
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In his 20s, Deol, like most youngsters from Punjab's Doaba region, too was keen to move to Canada and settle there. But fate had other plans and his visa didn't work out. Deol's father Harbhajan Singh was already a noted pastor who had converted in 1988 under the influence of an Australian pastor—running against the pattern, being from the powerful Jat Sikh community. Deol inherited his father's Open Door Church, among the oldest Pentecostal churches in Punjab. "My father was, but I was never devoutly religious. My experiences with his colleagues, their respect for him and, above all, my own experience with Christian leaders transformed me," Deol says. A preacher since 2012, he is now constructing a church on a one-acre piece of land adjacent to his ministry. His Sunday sermons and healing sessions are among the most sought-after; he claims to have healed even cancer patients through the power of prayer. Currently, Deol is busy putting a structure to PCPC (the Pentecostal Church Prabandhak Committee), which he founded and now heads, to organise Pentecostal pastors.